About 300,000 government users in Germany shift to Nextcloud for file sharing

The German Federal Information Technology Center (ITZBund) has chosen Nextcloud as its collaboration and file sharing platform. As a result, approximately 300,000 government users will now be using open source.

ITZBund is using Nextcloud Enterprise Subscription to gain access to the operational, scaling and security expertise of Nextcloud GmbH as well as long term support of the software.

Nextcloud arrived on Germany's tech scene in 2016 after Frank Karlitschek, co-founder of the open source Infrastructure as a Service (IaaS) cloud program OwnCloud, forked the software to create a more open source model. ITZBund, whose 2,700 IT admins run IT operations for about a million government workers, kicked off a pilot in 2016 covering about 5,000 end users with a variety of devices for which it needed to enable file-syncing support for Windows, Android and iOS products.

ITZBund has rolled out a collaboration and cloud storage tool called BC-Box, which employees can use to move data to the cloud and access it. Nextcloud was able to deliver the required Outlook add-on integration to allow users to send secure links rather than file attachments.

Nextcloud won a tender for a federal secure file exchange system in late 2017 to supply its services and support for three years. The company says it differs from public clouds offered by the likes of Amazon Web Services and Microsoft by offering customers local data storage.

"The procurement process was for the construction of a private cloud for the federal government," shared a company official from ITZBund.

Nextcloud's Karlitschek said it offered better security than public cloud providers because "…you can run our software in its own data centre, which you trust, and anyone can inspect the code, and check for security vulnerabilities, anytime, anywhere, and then make changes, if necessary."

The move follows a cabinet resolution passed earlier, which applies to the government's main Web portal, *gov.il*. Other government services are also being encouraged to open their source code.

The rationale is that the code was developed at public expense and should therefore be accessible to members of the public.

Deep learning platform launched by Linux Foundation

The Linux Foundation already supports multiple open source foundations and projects like Cloud Foundry, the Cloud Native Computing Foundation, CNI, CodeAurora, IOTivity and many more. It has added another feather to its cap by flagging off the LF Deep Learning Foundation (LF DLF) in March 2018. This foundation supports open source inventions in artificial intelligence, machine learning and deep learning. It also makes these valuable technologies easily accessible to data scientists and developers all around the world.

The LF Deep Learning Foundation was started by Amdocs, B.Yond, AT&T, Baidu, Huawei, Nokia, Tech Mahindra, Tencent, Univa and ZTE, a consortium of firms. The aim is to provide a neutral space where developers will be able to collaborate for speedy and widespread adoption of deep learning technologies.

Long term deep learning strategies can evolve on this platform, and it can offer support to various projects based on AI, machine learning and deep learning ecosystems. One of the projects already launched by the LF DLF is Acumos AI, which will provide a platform where it is easy to create, share, discover and apply machine learning, deep learning and analytics models, eventually making the potential of AI accessible to more users. AT&T and Tech Mahindra have provided the initial code for the Acumos AI project.

Soon the LF DLF will feature projects from Baidu and Tencent. The Baidu's EDL project equips Kubernetes with elastic scheduling and uses PaddlePaddle's fault tolerant property to specifically improve the usage of Kubernetes clusters. For Big Data models, Tencent's Angel project provides a distributed high performing machine learning platform developed in collaboration with Peking University. Countless parameters can be supported by this project.

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